

ILIKEITDEEP · A GUIDED JOURNAL

The Business Idea Journal

From 'What If' to First Sale



printable pdf · 18 guided questions · build the thing

WELCOME

Before You Begin



You have an idea. It visits you in the shower, in traffic,
at 2 a.m. — and every time, you tell it 'someday.'

This journal is where someday gets a date.

These pages take your idea from a fuzzy 'what if' to
a clear plan with real first steps — not a 40-page business
plan nobody reads, but the honest questions that matter:

What is it? Who needs it? And what's the fastest way
to your first real sale?

Written by someone who started with an idea and a phone.

Your turn.

STARTING POINT

The Idea, Out Loud



Write your idea like you're excitedly telling your best friend — what it is, who it's for, and why it keeps tugging at you.

PART ONE

The Idea



Fuzzy ideas stay dreams. Clear ideas become businesses.

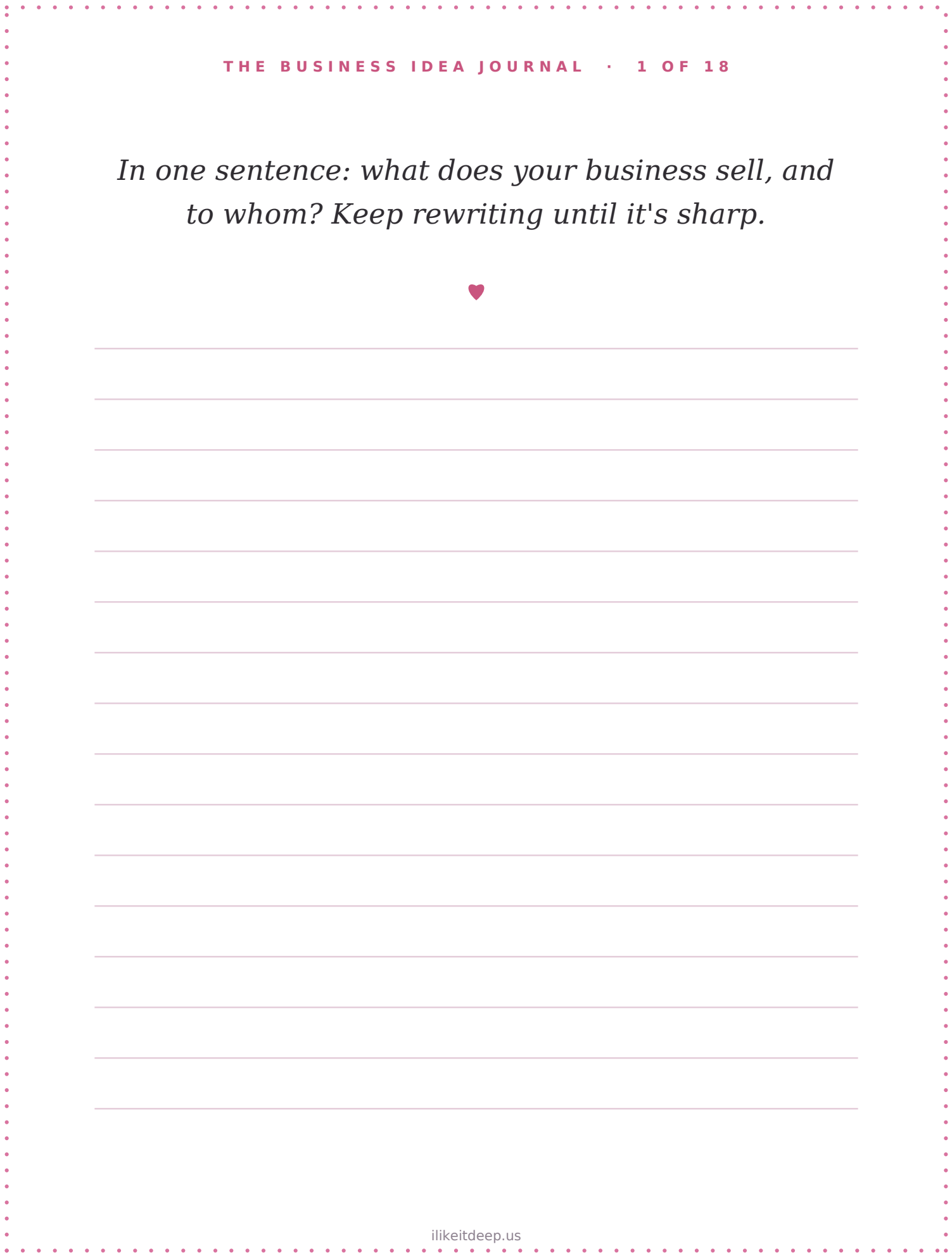
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THE BUSINESS IDEA JOURNAL · 1 OF 18

*In one sentence: what does your business sell, and
to whom? Keep rewriting until it's sharp.*

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THE BUSINESS IDEA JOURNAL · 1 OF 18

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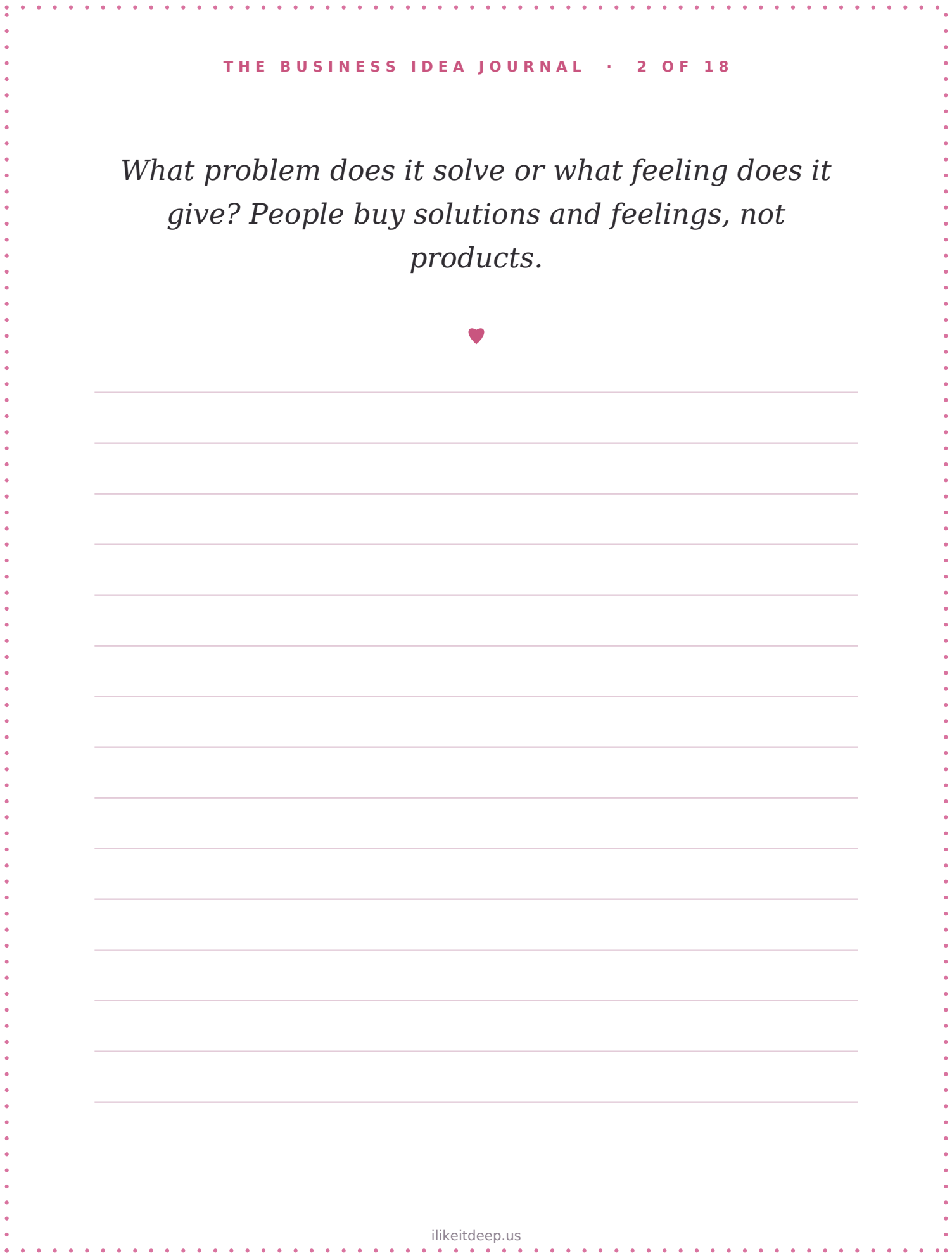
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What problem does it solve or what feeling does it give? People buy solutions and feelings, not products.

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THE BUSINESS IDEA JOURNAL · 2 OF 18

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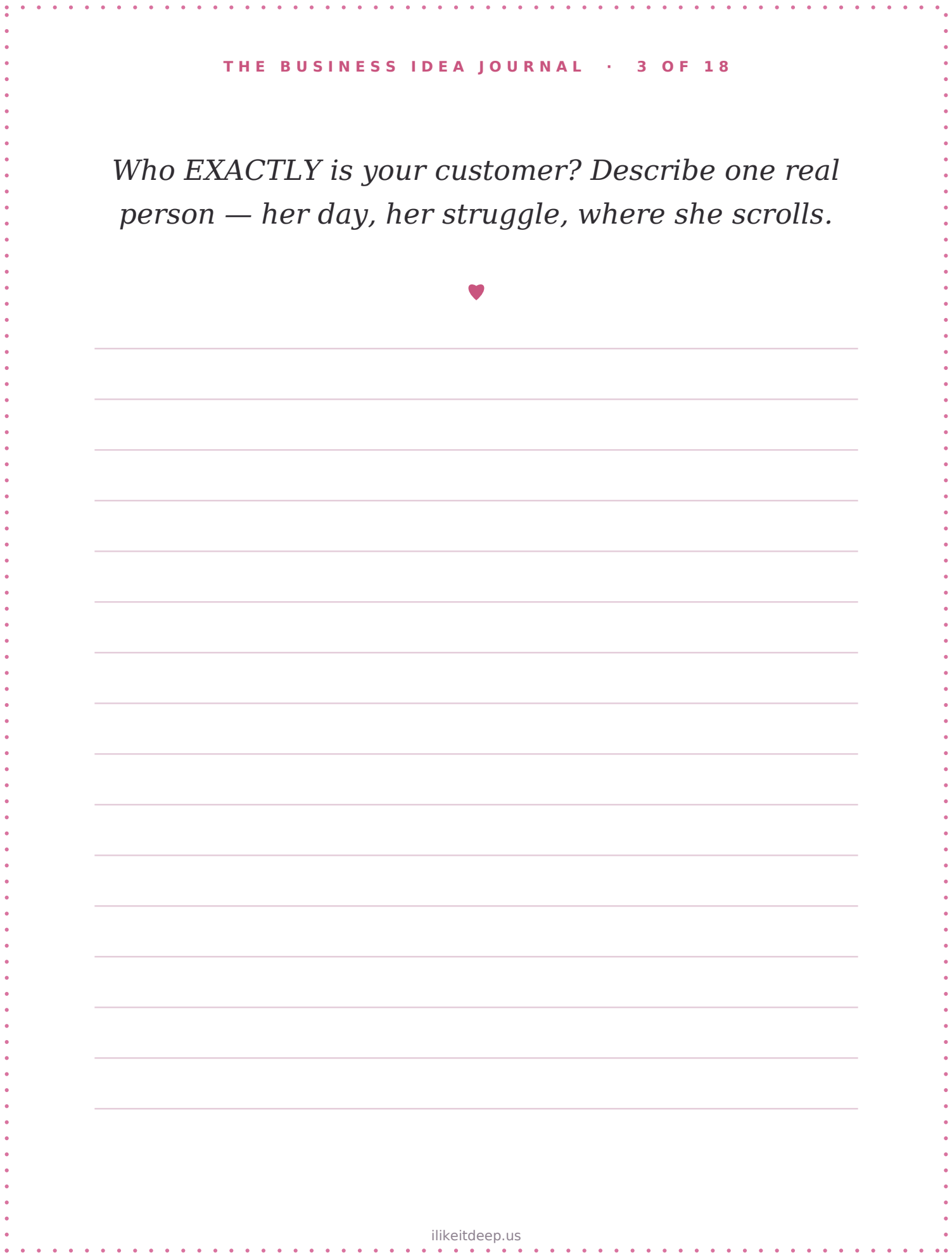
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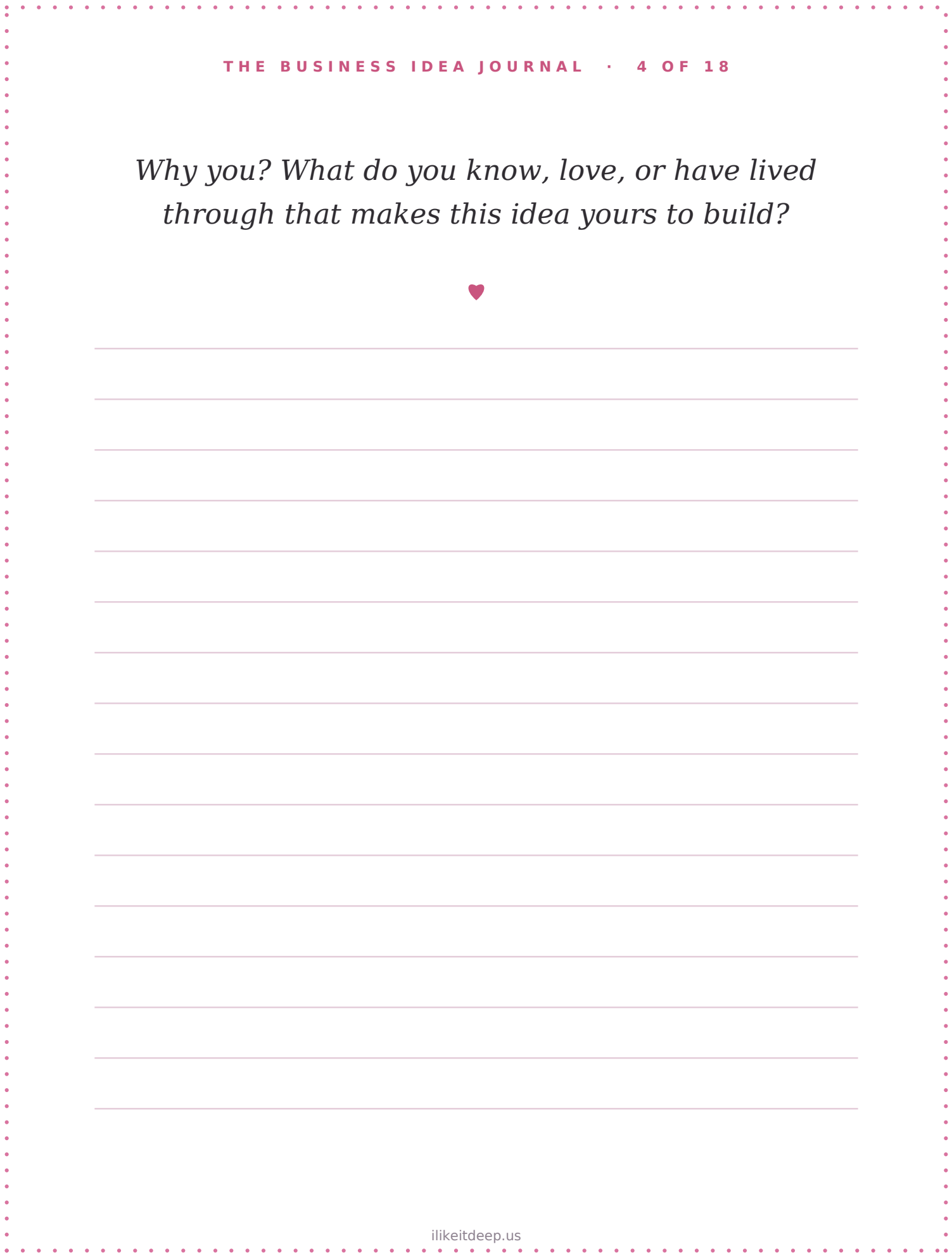
THE BUSINESS IDEA JOURNAL • 3 OF 18

Who EXACTLY is your customer? Describe one real person — her day, her struggle, where she scrolls.

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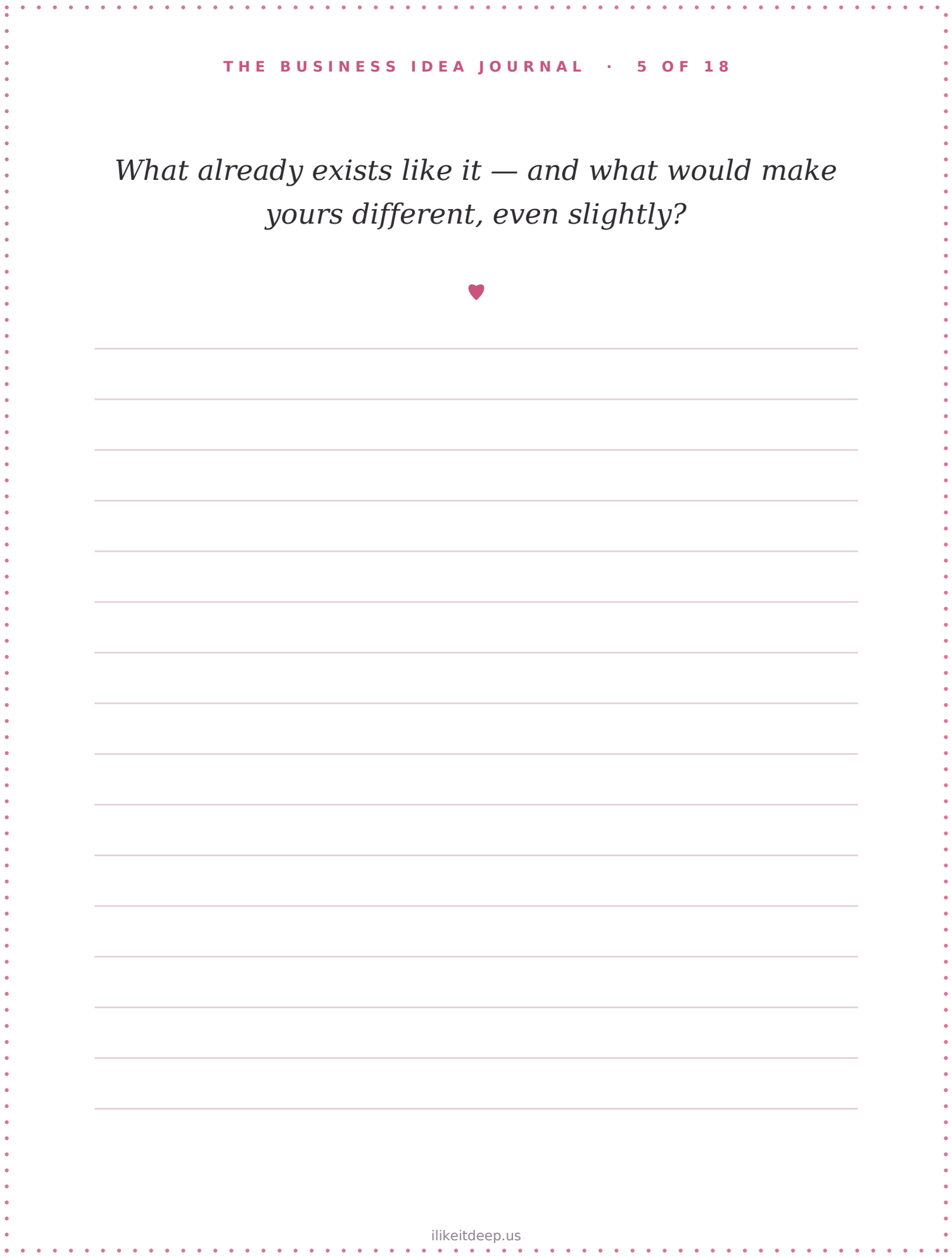
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THE BUSINESS IDEA JOURNAL • 5 OF 18

What already exists like it — and what would make yours different, even slightly?

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THE BUSINESS IDEA JOURNAL • 5 OF 18

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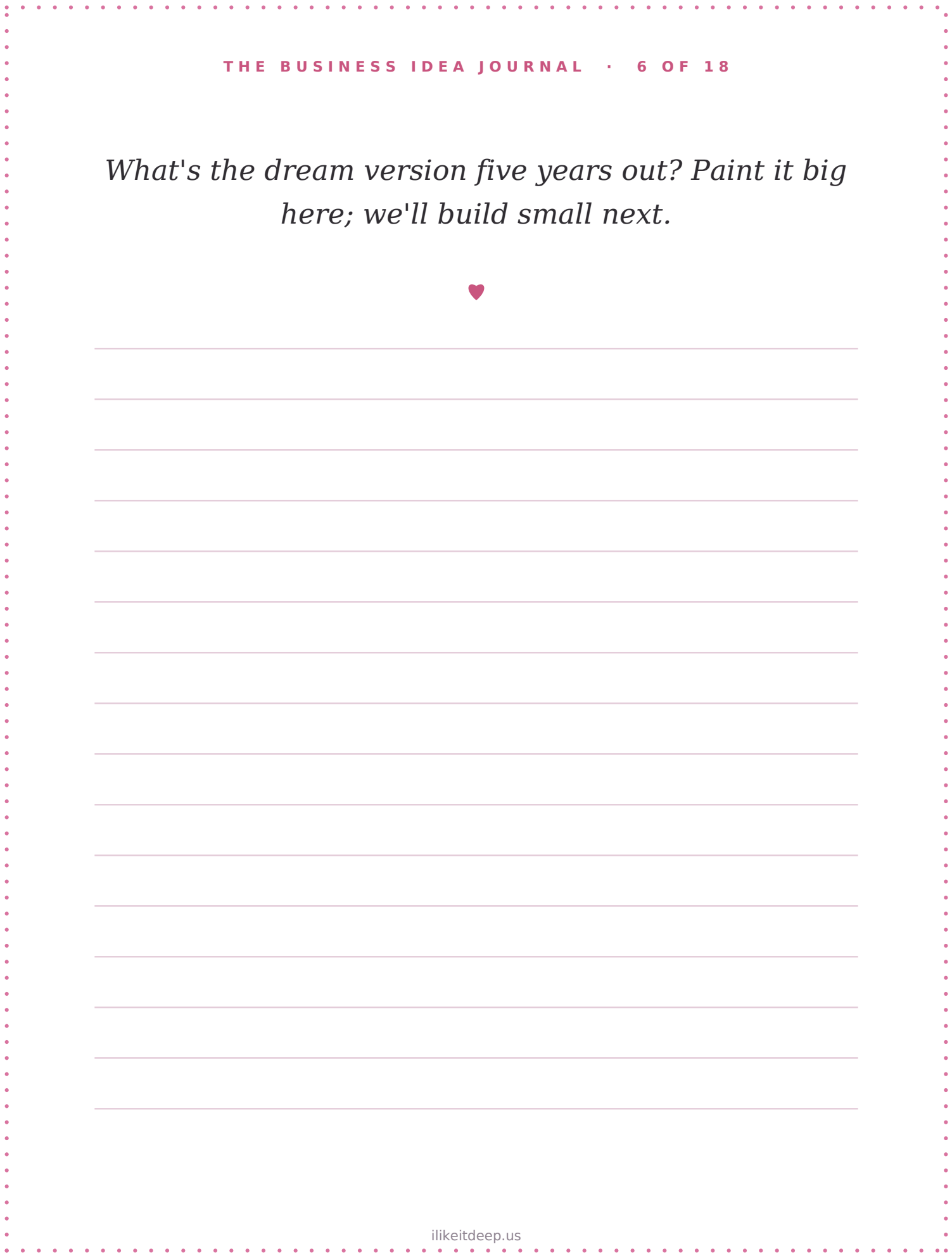
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THE BUSINESS IDEA JOURNAL · 6 OF 18

What's the dream version five years out? Paint it big here; we'll build small next.

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THE BUSINESS IDEA JOURNAL · 6 OF 18

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PART TWO

The Reality Check

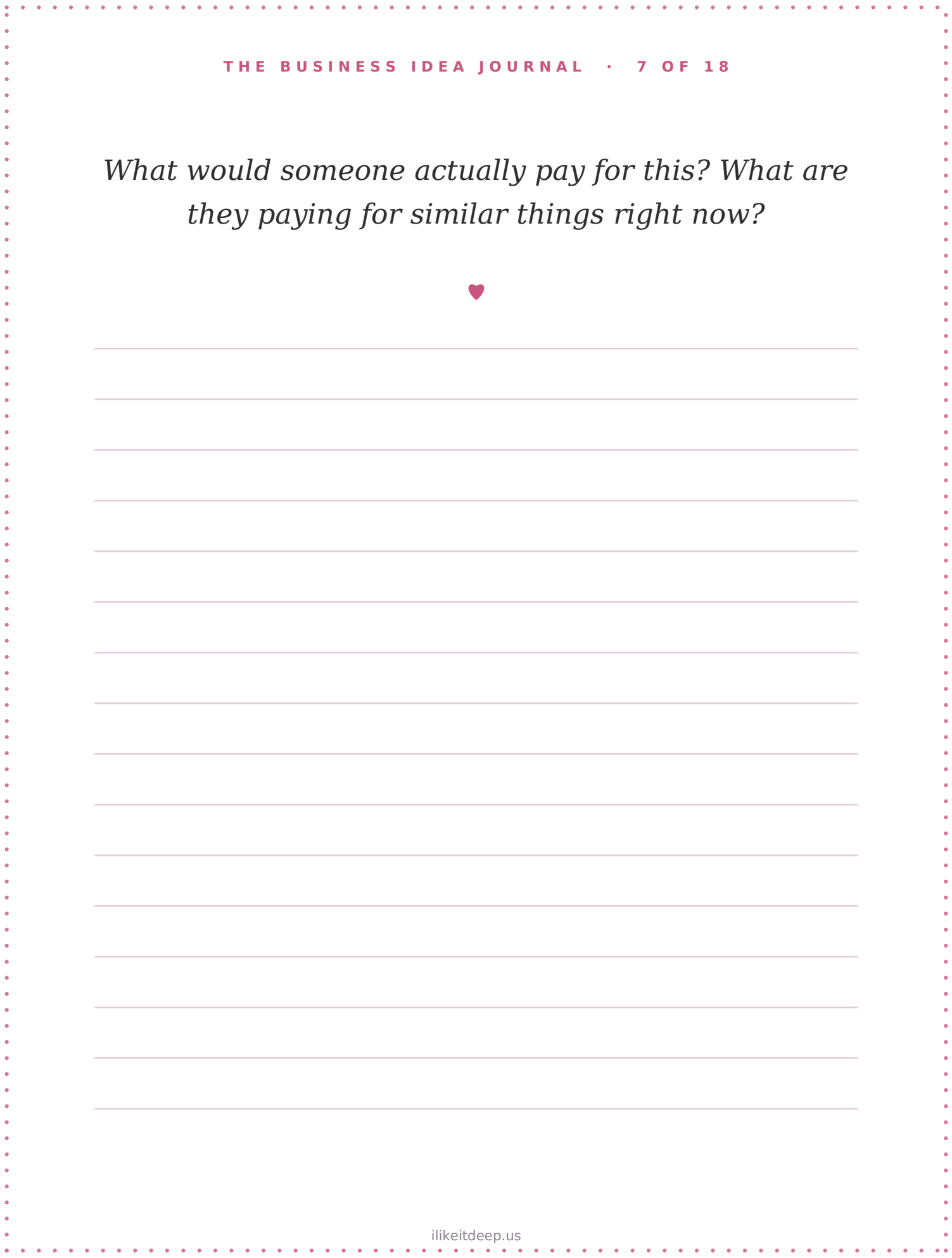


*Loving your idea is step one. Testing it is step
two. Both are acts of respect.*

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What would someone actually pay for this? What are they paying for similar things right now?

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THE BUSINESS IDEA JOURNAL · 7 OF 18

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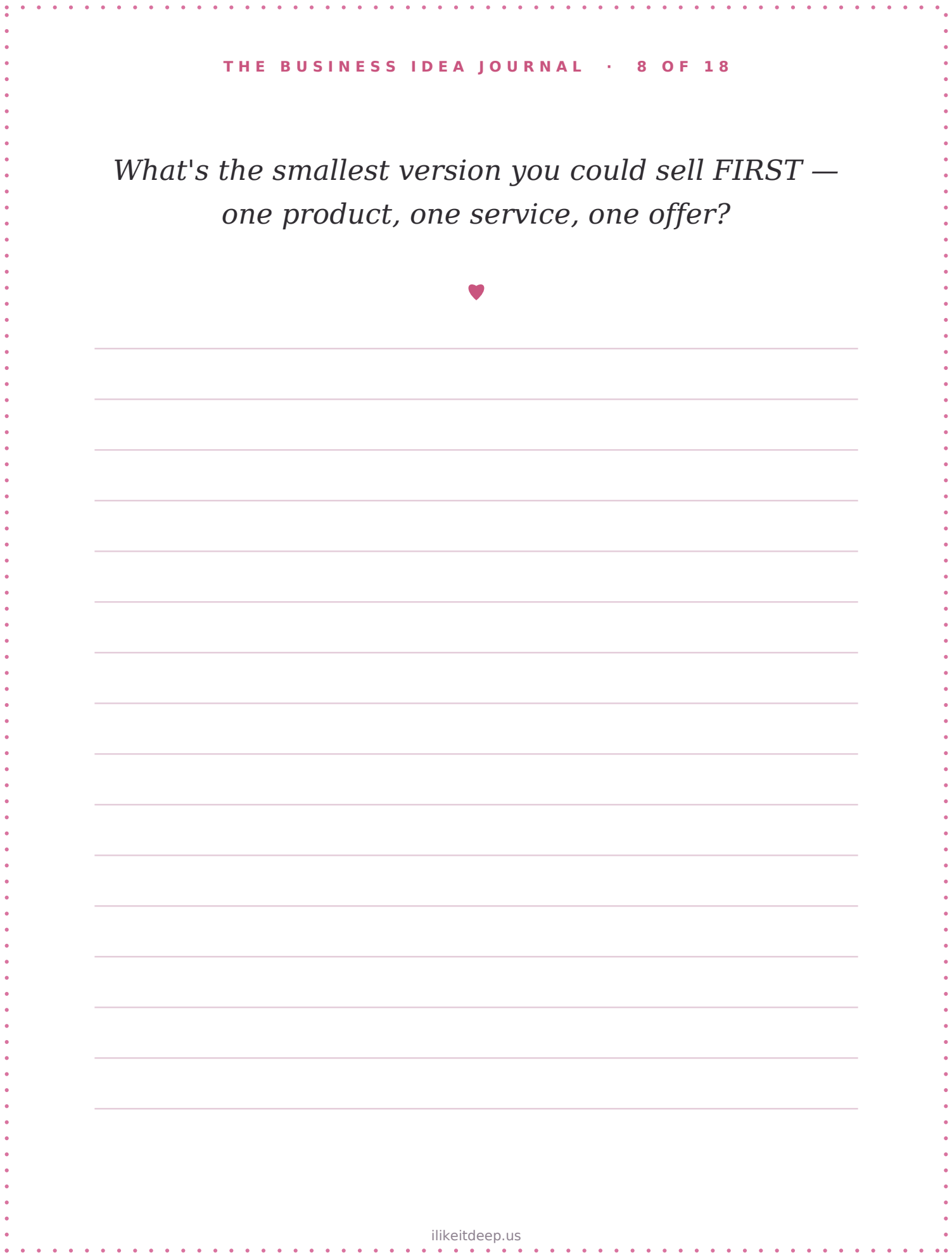
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THE BUSINESS IDEA JOURNAL · 8 OF 18

*What's the smallest version you could sell FIRST —
one product, one service, one offer?*

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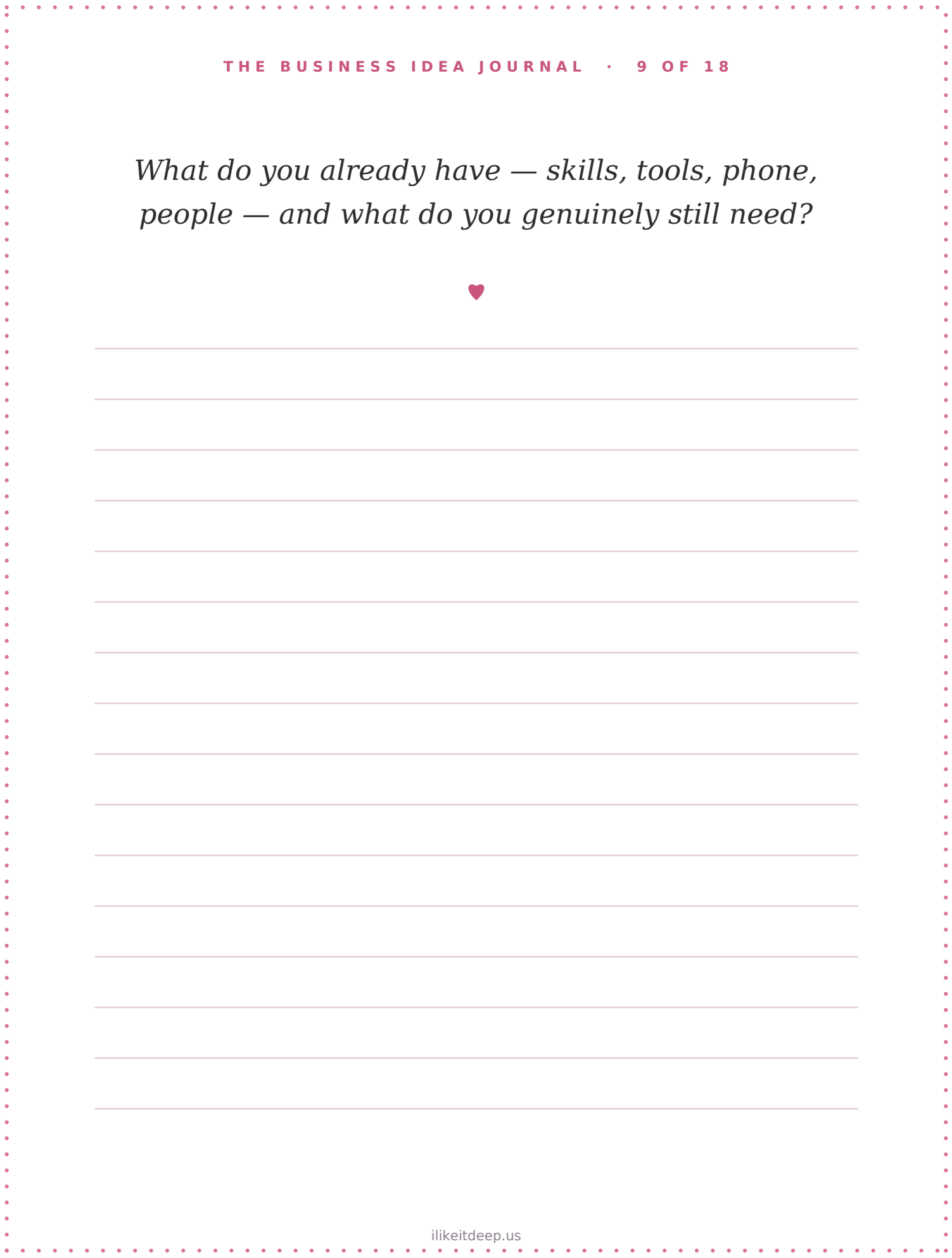
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*What do you already have — skills, tools, phone,
people — and what do you genuinely still need?*

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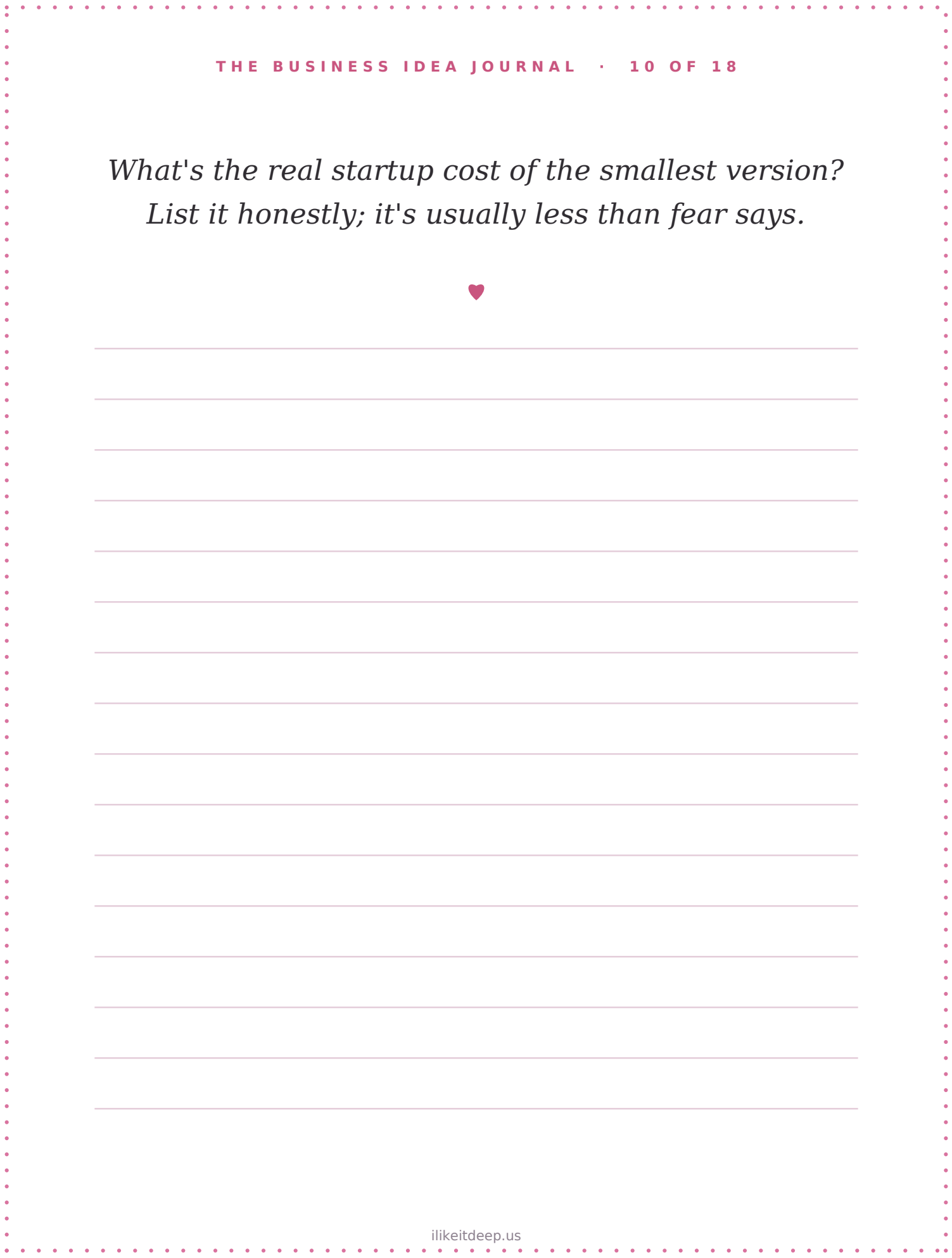
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*What's the real startup cost of the smallest version?
List it honestly; it's usually less than fear says.*

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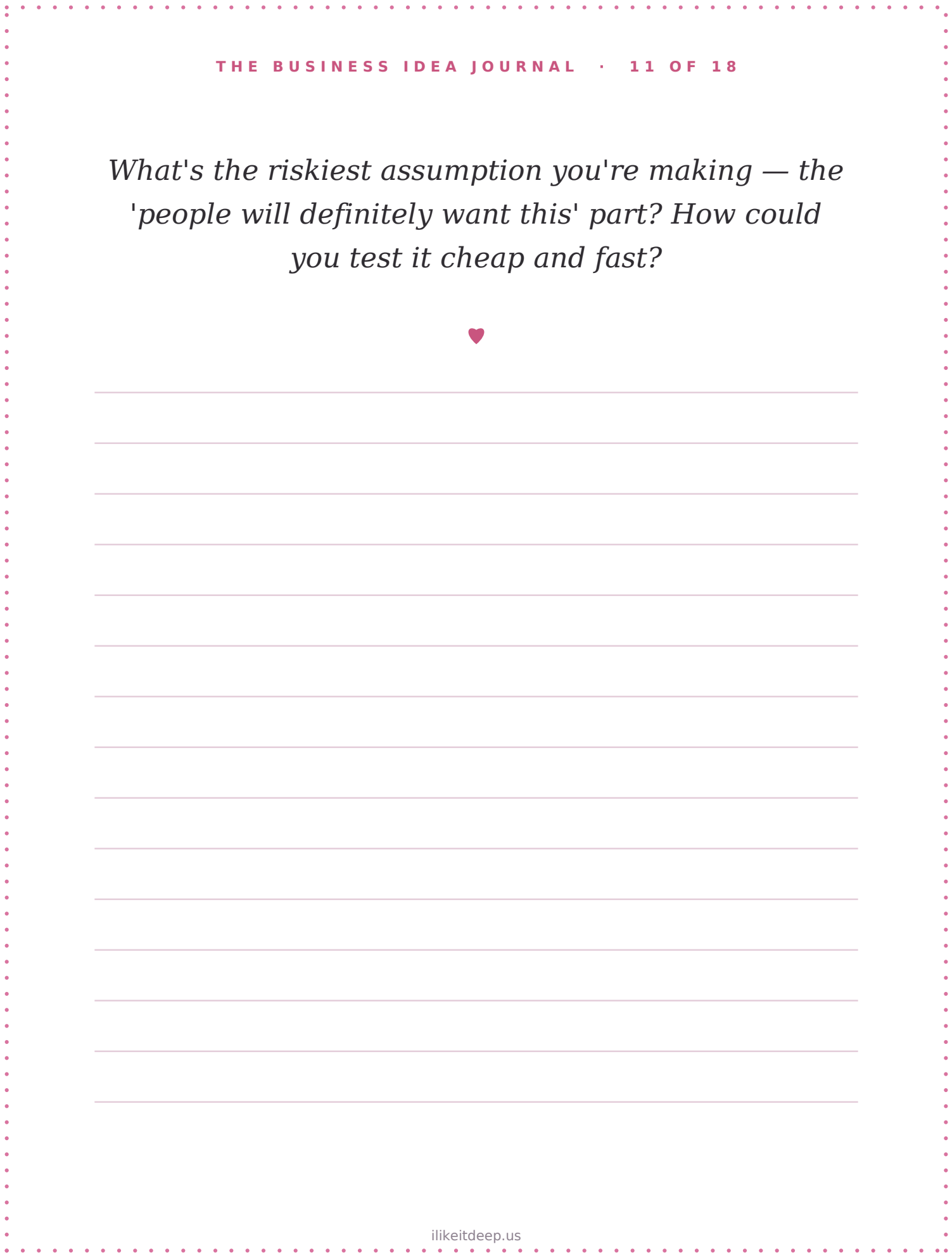
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*What's the riskiest assumption you're making — the
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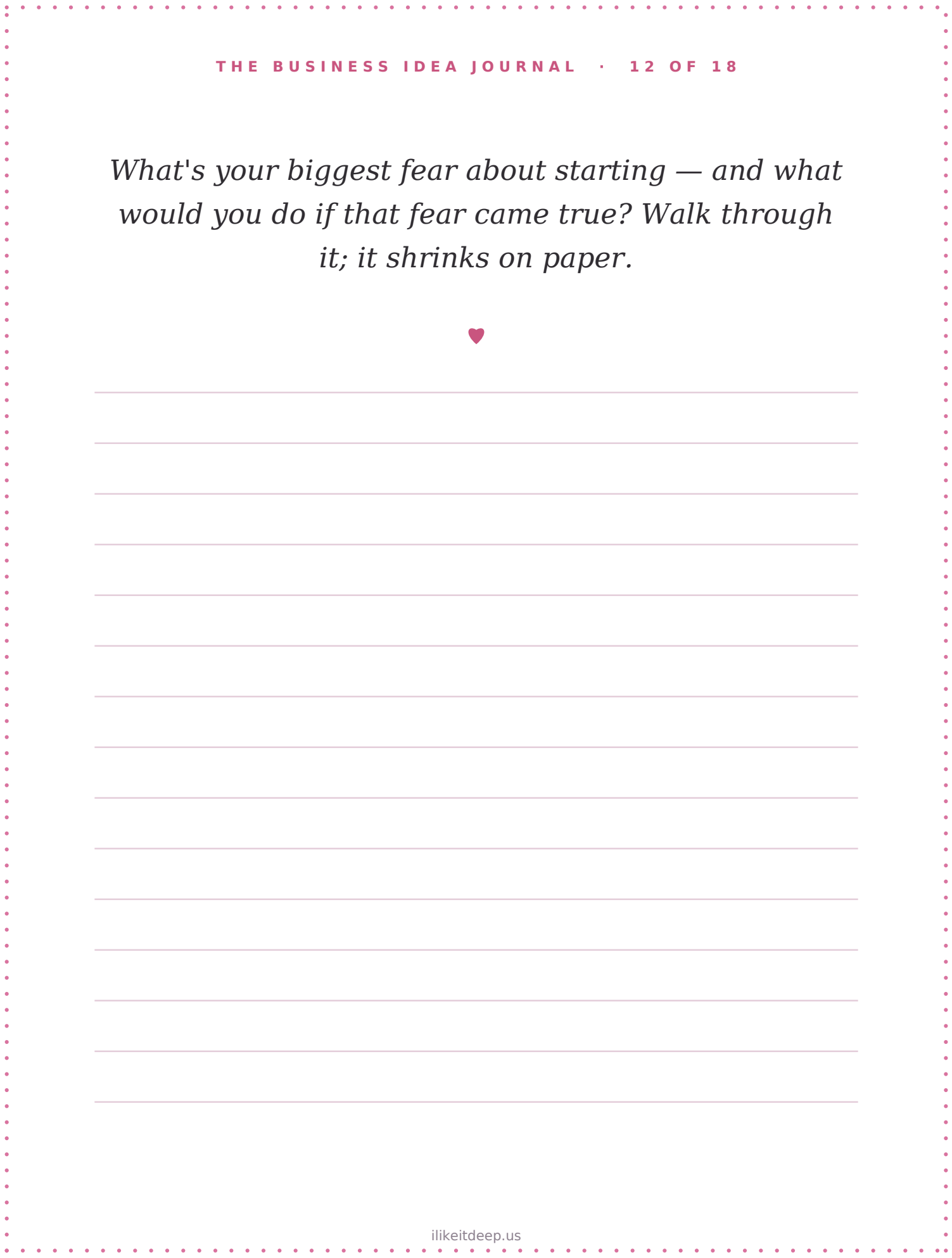
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What's your biggest fear about starting — and what would you do if that fear came true? Walk through it; it shrinks on paper.

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THE BUSINESS IDEA JOURNAL · 12 OF 18

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PART THREE

First Moves

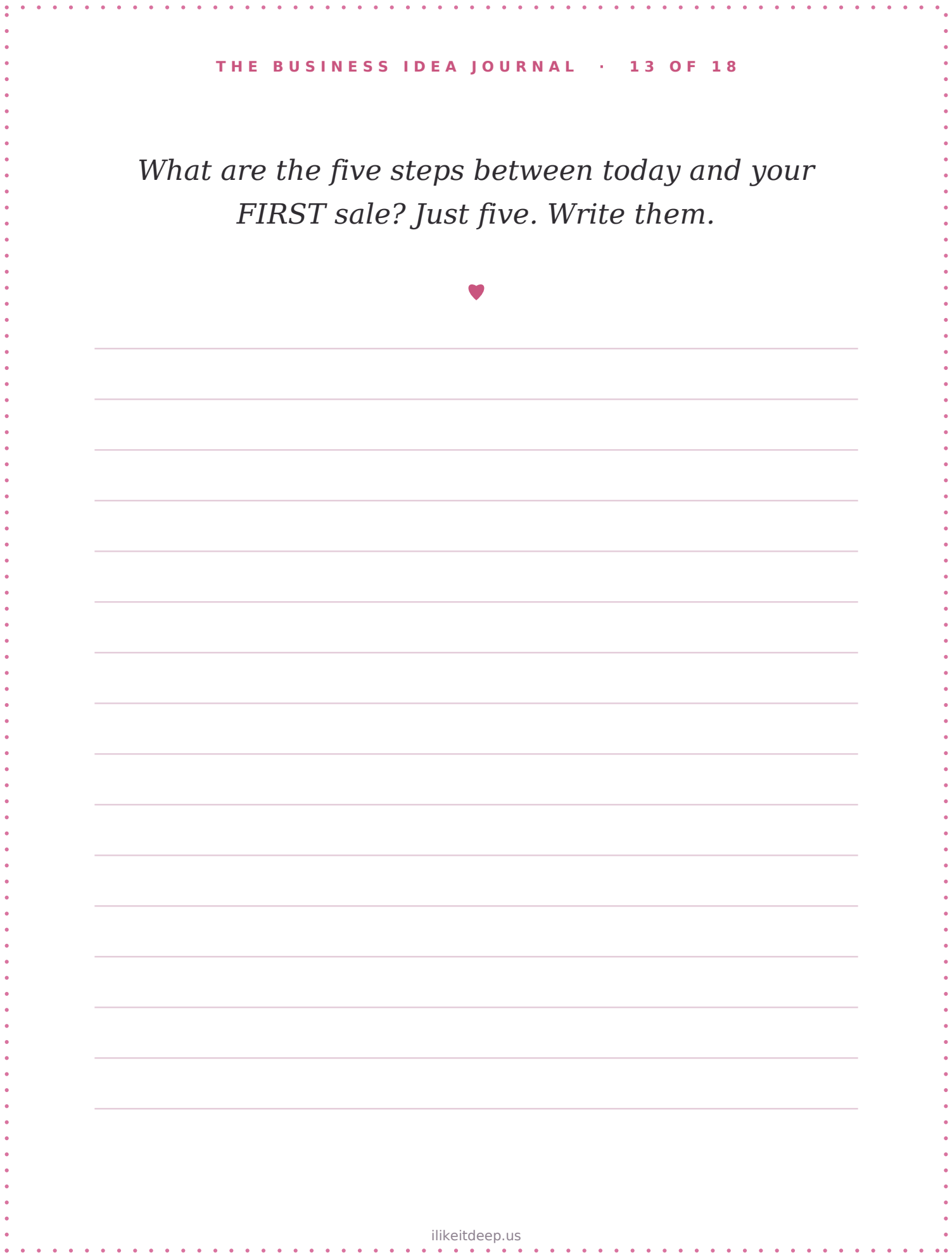


*Businesses aren't launched. They're started —
small, scrappy, and this week.*

THE BUSINESS IDEA JOURNAL · 13 OF 18

*What are the five steps between today and your
FIRST sale? Just five. Write them.*

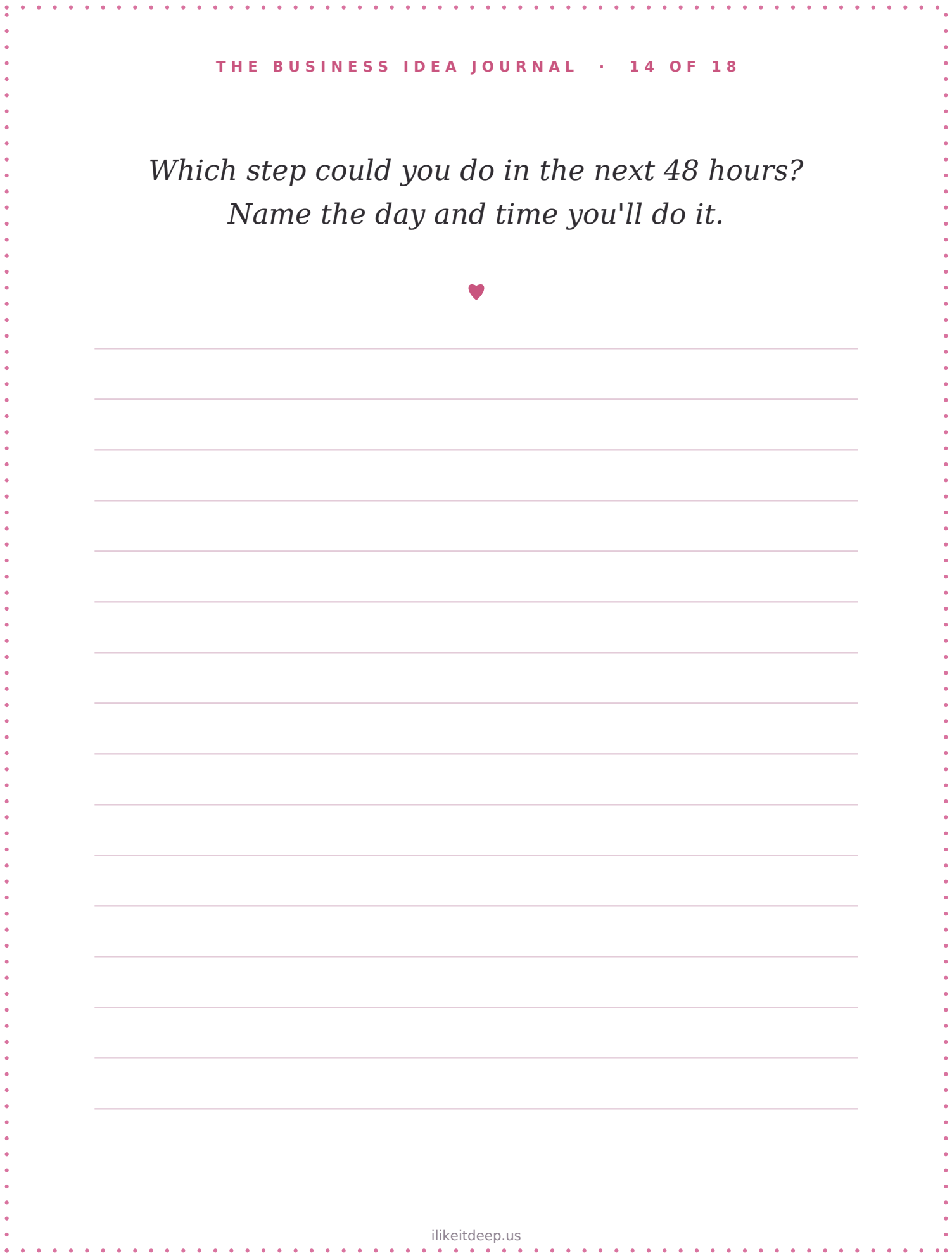
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*What are the five steps between today and your
FIRST sale? Just five. Write them.*

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*Which step could you do in the next 48 hours?
Name the day and time you'll do it.*

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How will people find you — one platform, done well? Pick it and claim your name there this week.

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What will you charge at launch? Decide now, in writing, so doubt can't renegotiate later.

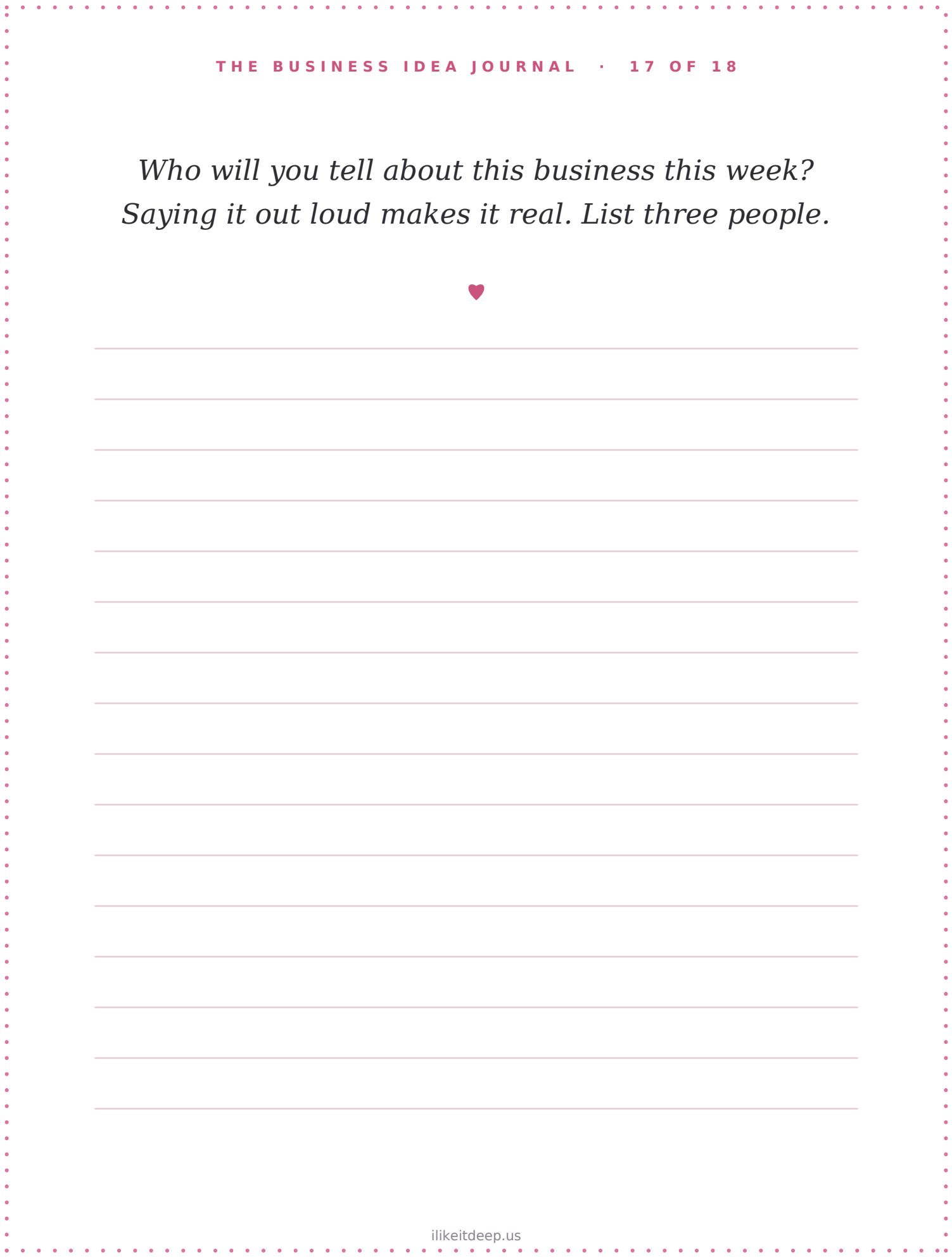
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*Who will you tell about this business this week?
Saying it out loud makes it real. List three people.*

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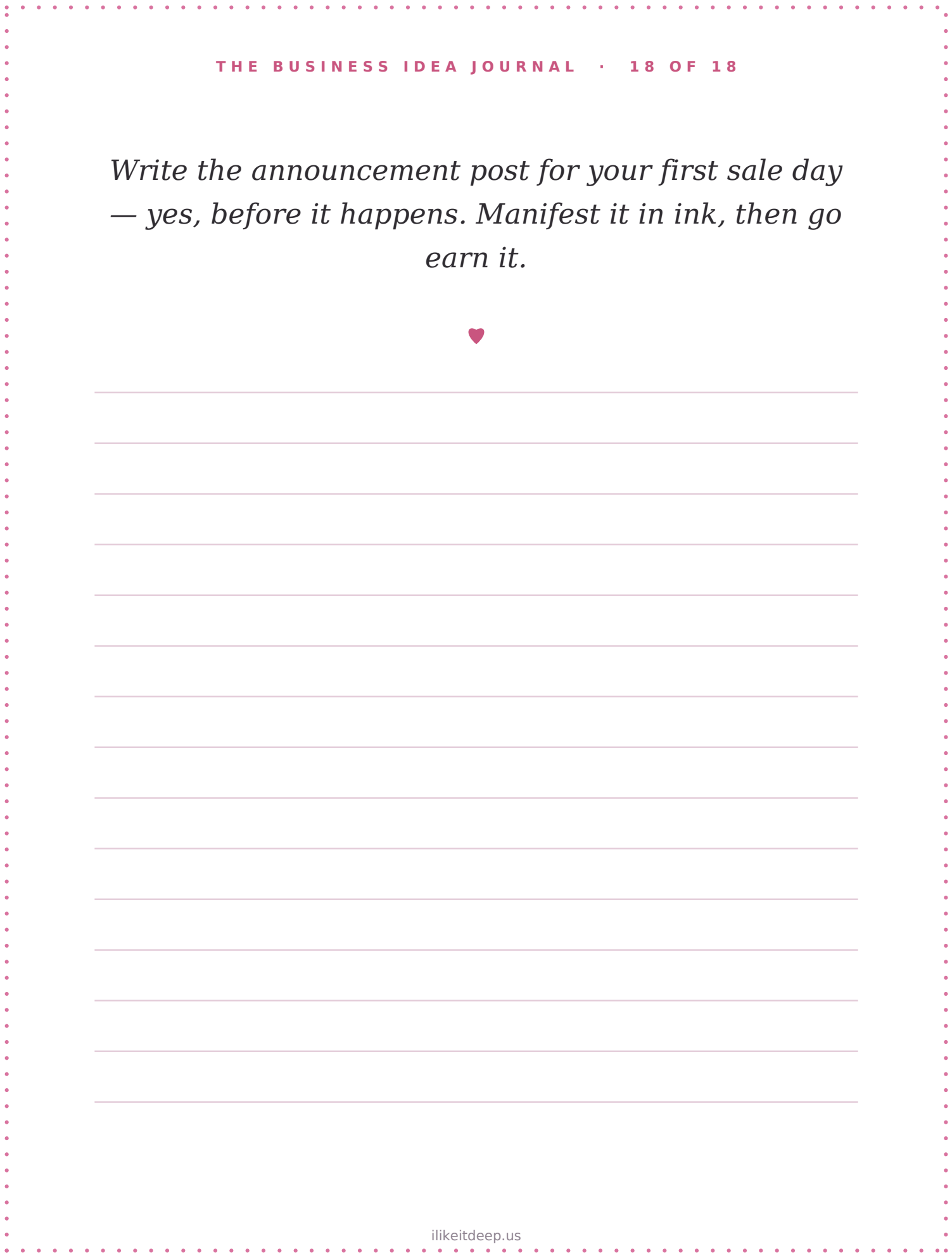
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*Write the announcement post for your first sale day
— yes, before it happens. Manifest it in ink, then go
earn it.*

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The Stop-Waiting Checklist



For the weeks the dream stalls. Check what's true, then get moving.

- ☐ Done is better than perfect — ship the scrappy version
- ☐ One imperfect post beats zero perfect ones
- ☐ Research time is capped: learn 20 minutes, do 40
- ☐ The name, logo, and fonts are NOT the business — the offer is
- ☐ Ask one real person if they'd buy it, today
- ☐ Price it, say it out loud, don't apologize for it
- ☐ Small first sale > big someday plan
- ☐ Fear of judgment fades; regret compounds
- ☐ Track one number weekly: offers made
- ☐ Tell someone your next step so it has a witness

BONUS · KEEP THIS PAGE

Wins & Firsts



First follower, first sale, first review, first repeat customer — log every milestone here. Future you will read this page and cry a little.

























BEFORE YOU CLOSE THIS JOURNAL

A Note, From One Human to Another



Every business you admire started exactly here:
one person, one idea, one scary first step.
The only difference between them and the dreamers
is they started before they felt ready.

You now have what most people never make:
a clear idea, a tested plan, and a first move
with a date on it.

Go sell the thing. Then come sign this page.



*Someday just got a date. Go build the
thing.*



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